

AMERICAN EXPRESS

ABOUT THE COMPANY

American Express (Amex) is a **global financial services company**, best known for its premium credit cards, payment solutions, and customer service. Founded in 1850, it operates in over 130 countries and is ranked among the world's most valuable brands.

For professionals, **Amex offers strong career opportunities in areas such as technology, analytics, finance, operations, risk management, and customer service. The company emphasizes career growth, learning programs, and a culture of inclusion and collaboration.**

In India, American Express has a significant presence since 1921, with its largest center of excellence in Gurugram. Thousands of employees here contribute to global operations, innovation, and customer experience, making it an attractive workplace for those seeking growth in financial services and technology.

JOB ROLE

Intern – Technology – 8 weeks summer internship programme

ELIGIBILITY

- Minimum CGPA: 7
- No active backlogs

1. Online Test

The assessment was conducted on the Codility platform and included 3 problem-solving questions:

1. Subarray Maximum Sum Problem – From a given integer array, find a subarray that both starts and ends with the same element, and calculate the maximum possible sum among such subarrays.
2. Garbage Truck Scheduling – A row of houses has different types of waste (Metal, Plastic, Glass). Separate trucks are assigned to each waste type. Each truck travels to the farthest house of its type, collects the waste (taking 1 minute per bag), and returns. The task was to compute the overall time taken (maximum among all trucks).

3. Grid Navigation with Constraints – An assassin has to move from a starting cell to the bottom-right corner of an $n \times m$ grid. Guards monitor straight lines in their direction until blocked, and all cells under their vision are unsafe. Obstacles are also present. The task was to determine if the assassin can safely reach the target cell under these conditions.

2. Interview

The interviews were conducted in virtual mode and had two rounds.

i) Technical Interview

Duration: 30 - 35 minutes

The round started with a self-introduction followed by a detailed discussion on my projects. The interviewer asked many questions about:

- The tech stack I used
- The reasoning behind choosing those technologies
- Design choices and scalability

One problem I was asked:

👉 A file contains dates. How would you sort it?

Since I had recently completed a related course on Coursera, I confidently explained the solution using Pandas (`read_csv`) and Python datetime functions, describing the complete workflow. The interviewer was satisfied with my explanation.

Finally, I was asked if I had any questions. I inquired about how freshers feel when they first join Amex and about the work culture.

ii) HR Interview

Duration: 45 minutes

This round was largely focused on **my projects, behavior, and communication.**

The interviewer asked me to explain one project from idea to completion. I chose my **Data Science Capstone Project – Success Prediction of Falcon 9 Rocket Launches**

🚀. I described the source of the idea, the dataset, methodology, and outcomes.

Since it was unique compared to common projects, it created a positive impression.

Other key areas of discussion:

- Challenges I faced during projects
- How quickly I can adapt to new languages/technologies
- Handling pressure and managing time effectively
- My interests, favorite subject, and future learning goals

Similar to the technical round, I ended by asking about company culture and fresher experience at Amex.

TIPS

- ✓ Be clear and confident while explaining your projects, as they form the core of the discussion.
- ✓ If you don't know something, it's okay to admit it – show your willingness to learn.
- ✓ Prepare for scenario-based questions with real-life examples (challenges, teamwork, achievements, failures).
- ✓ Research the company and role beforehand; it makes your answers more aligned.
- ✓ Maintain a positive attitude and sound confident throughout.

Wishing you all the best for your future goals.